

Hi there

Let's Talk About Bringing Home a Sibling

Welcoming a new member to the family can bring up some unwanted behavior in toddlers. Here's the truth: This baby (or babies) IS the best thing that will ever happen to your toddler and we are going to treat it as such! Watching a family serve the youngest and weakest member is a beautiful and important thing that your toddler gets to be apart of!

Sneak Peek into
the ***Moms on Call***
Parenting Books and
Online Courses!



Moms on Call

Bringing home a new baby with a toddler at home can be a beautiful experience for your family.



This is a BIG adjustment for your toddler, so let's discuss what to say, what to do, and what to avoid during this shift in the family dynamic!

What to Say:

Stay confident in delivery, and do not make "Stress Face" (furrowed brows). Use these statements with confidence!



"Babies take more of (Insert parental title)'s time. You will be just fine."



"Babies cry sometimes; it is normal, he/she/they will be just fine."



"You can touch the baby lightly on their feet and arms. You are great at that! You really know how to treat your sister/brother."

What to Do:

♥ Take the time that you need to serve this baby and get the rest you need.

♥ Extend tons of grace!

Those first two weeks are a transition period for the entire family.

This journey is new, and there will be bumps in the road; that is completely normal!

♥ Order the [Moms on Call Basic Baby Care Resources](#) to set great routines in place and promote rest for everyone.

Be sure your toddler is also following a Typical Day Routine appropriate for their age. This can be found in the [Moms on Call No Nonsense Toddler Book](#) and [Online Course](#).

♥ Allow your toddler to help!

Have them bring you the diaper bag, blanket, etc, to give them a role and chance to provide a helping hand!

♥ Keep items accessible to the toddler for when you are unable to assist.

Keep a small basket filled with your toddler's favorite snacks and toddler-sized water bottles where they can reach it so they feel independent in getting themselves a snack.



What to Do:

♥ **Treat this like it is the best thing that could've happened (because it is).**

♥ **Give your household time to adjust.**

Things may seem crazy for a few weeks. Give it about a month to adjust!

♥ **Use your helpers!**

Enlist others and family members to engage your toddler.

Allow your toddler to broaden their circle of caregivers.

This is for a season.

♥ **Allow your toddler to help!**

Give your toddler time to explore the baby and have time with you and the baby together as much as they are interested.

♥ **Compliment your toddler, within ears' reach to another adult/caregiver.**

“I knew (insert toddler’s name) would be a great big brother/sister. This takes some getting used to but he/she is doing a wonderful job. It is fun to be a family”

♥ **Talk to your toddler when their heart is open. We call this between awake and asleep.**

During the night time routine, talk to your toddler about the progress they are making welcoming their new family member.

“Being a big brother/sister takes some getting used to, but you are doing a wonderful job! This is what it is like to be apart of a family of _ (insert # of people in the household) and we love it, the hard parts and the easy ones.”



What to Avoid:

Here's the tricky part. The things we want to avoid as our toddler goes through this transition.



Feeling guilty.

The world does not revolve around your toddler, so don't feel guilty about the extra time you are spending with baby.



Underestimating their capability.

Your toddler can and will adjust! Don't underestimate their capability to do so!



Making "Stress Face".

Do not make Stress Face to your toddler all day long because you do not have the same amount of time to give them right now.

Stay confident, and let your face show this!



Allowing your toddler to come sleep with you.

Don't break the cycle of your consistent routine.

Try and find time during the day instead to get in a few extra snuggles!



Feeling solely responsible for this big adjustment.

This change in your family is an adjustment for everyone!

As baby grows, you will find time (as a family) to balance it all, and give your toddler those extra special moments as well.

Remember, this adjustment period is just a season!





You've got this!

Follow along with Moms on Call's No Nonsense Toddler Tips/Cheat Sheets and more for additional tips on adjustments like this one. They can be found in the [Toddler Online Resources](#) and [Book!](#)

